OMER BESE

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SUMMARY

Energy systems engineer and founder. Work from the primary text: read the tariff, power contract or statute, find the clause that decides the cost, and build the tool that prices it. Most recent: an independent case study of the power contract for the Hawesville, Kentucky campus Anthropic has leased, built with Claude from public filings. Started on contractor-side LADWP rebate projects, then co-launched an industrial energy-audit program at the Istanbul Chamber of Industry. Built WattShed independently; now looking to do this work inside a team.

EXPERIENCE

WATTSHED

July 2026 to Present

Founder and Engineer

Los Angeles

Community energy programs for data centers | wattshed.co

- Published the Hawesville power contract case study, an independent reading of the power contract for the 482 MW Hawesville, Kentucky campus that TeraWulf is building and Anthropic has leased, from public filings (Kentucky PSC case 2026-00115): a live model and a 2-page memo. The billing floor starts once a 30-minute peak passes 50 MW, or at a completion notice if earlier, so on an assumed nine-month ramp the campus is billed at least $9.7M for power not yet drawn; a 241 MW start would pay $3.2M of floor charges instead of $9.7M.
- Built Lens, the model behind the study, as an MCP server. Claude prices any term live, pulls one power assumptions sheet (when power arrives, how much, how reliable, at what cost) and reads the stakeholder record: 10 parties including the PSC and the Attorney General, 10 deciding dates including MISO's answer to FERC's large-load show-cause order (EL26-70) and Kentucky's 2027 session (a possible HB 593 successor), each graded by source, and 7 unknowns.
- Also priced in the study (modeled): the capacity charge sits outside the floor and is set on a seasonal peak the campus names by each 1 October, so naming a summer peak 10% lower and holding to it nets about $1.7M a year. The campus buys MISO energy at the hourly price, and gas set MISO's real-time price in 63% of intervals in 2024, so each $1 per MMBtu adds about $17M a year to its power bill.
- Ratepayer test in the study, on a $10M household program (734 homes): about $123K a year is shifted to other Big Rivers customers if the credit is valued at Virginia's assumed $120 per kW-year; nothing is shifted if it is set at what the grid avoids.
- Wrote the Wythe County, Virginia case study in four days, in a market not worked in before: from Appalachian Power's Tariff 28, the SCC's large-load order and Va. Code 56-596.7, priced a $10M home upgrade and battery program near Fluidstack's campus at $5.1M to $8.5M net over 14 years, depending on the credit rule, and named the three terms in Appalachian Power's January 2027 filing that move the net cost most.
- Built the program runtime, live in production: funders set terms, households apply, contractors document the work, reviewers clear it, funders pay on verified results. About 2,000 unit tests.

BONJUUR

April 2022 to December 2025

Founder

New York & Los Angeles

- Built a housekeeping service and raised $90,000, $25,000 of it from Jason Calacanis after his pre-accelerator (one of roughly four funded from a cohort of about 150), getting him to break both of his rules: no solo founders, no service businesses.
- Cleaned houses personally every weekday for six months, more than 500 visits, to find the bottlenecks firsthand. First customer: Jordan Fliegel, Managing Director of Techstars NYC, right after Techstars rejected Bonjuur.

TULIP HAUS

March 2020 to October 2025

Co-Founder

New York

- Imported handmade Turkish home goods with a co-founder: sourcing, customs brokerage and tariff classification, ocean freight and fulfillment. Personally handled every invoice and import document.
- When a shipyard crane damaged the first container and the cargo insurer rejected the claim, pursued it with the shipyard operator directly, reading the coverage terms and shipping law along the way.

SPIROHOME

April 2019 to November 2019

Business Developer

Ankara, Turkey

- Oversaw FDA-clearance work for a battery-powered IoT medical device, coordinating hardware engineering, regulatory and sales; the company obtained clearance during the role. Opened its Amazon UK and EU stores in a restricted medical-device category in three months (usually ten).

ISTANBUL CHAMBER OF INDUSTRY

January 2018 to March 2019

Associate Specialist, Energy & Environment

Istanbul, Turkey

- Co-developed an industrial energy-audit program for a Chamber of more than 18,000 member manufacturers and launched it after about a year of approvals: the Chamber funded the equipment, Yıldız Technical University students audited member factories at no charge on real data, and professors oversaw the reports. Supervised the first audit, at Sümer Plastik's 12,000 m^2 factory.

NULARIS

November 2016 to November 2017

Energy Efficiency Engineer Los Angeles

- Worked at a small contractor on LADWP's preferred list for the Commercial Lighting Incentive Program. Ran rebate projects from application and LADWP pre-inspection to the post-installation audit before LADWP released funds, several at once over four-to-six-month cycles, at sites from small garages to the Four Seasons.
- Counted existing bulbs one by one for the audits, to Title 24 and ASHRAE standards. Most clients saw at least a 30% cut in lighting energy use. Replaced about half of the Jonathan Club's bulbs personally when crews were short-staffed.

PROJECTS

Built with AI agents, 2026. Solo except PowerUP (hackathon team of four).

PowerUP **Neighborhood islands for a home-battery fleet, hackathon build | October 2026 | github.com/mrbese/PowerUp | mrbese.github.io/PowerUp**

Top 20 at USC's InnovateLA Dual-Use Hackathon, on the Energy and Grid Hardening track sponsored by Base Power, in a team of four. Owned the energy design and directed the build with Claude Code: homes behind an SCE line switch run as one island on their batteries, SCE opens the switch and bills, and a utility officer approves the recharge. In the simulated replay at clear-sky solar, the 456-home pilot carries all 16 historical shutoffs.

ManorOS **Home energy auditor iOS app, live on the App Store | 2026 to Present | apps.apple.com/us/app/manoros/id6759580676**

For the peak-shaving release that follows the App Store build, built a demand-tariff dataset of 165 utilities in 34 states from NREL, OpenEI URDB and the tariff sheets: 73 verified with the governing sentence quoted and linked, after three research and four verification rounds re-checked 96 claims. Includes a bill check for LADWP's Power Access Charge, in effect a demand ratchet measured in kWh.

Re_Tera **Insurance-policy investigator for homeowners and renters, live on the App Store | 2026 to Present | getretera.com**

- Reads a homeowner's or renter's policy, explains the coverage in plain language and flags gaps, sublimits and exclusions, checking findings against state insurance statutes. Behind it is a statute corpus covering all 50 states, more than 95,000 sections. Every statute citation in an answer is checked against that corpus, and any that is not found is replaced with a visible marker.
- To decide how to keep the corpus current, tested on five states whether a search index of government documents could find amendments by itself. It found 52% of 75 hand-verified amendments, so it is used only for leads. One lead was Alaska's 2025 omnibus insurance act (SB 132, 57 sections amended), which the amendment records had missed.

EDUCATION

M.S. Sustainability Management | Columbia University **2015 to 2016**

New York

Coursework in Energy Markets and Innovation and Solar Project Development. WWF capstone: all nine teammates rejected the UHT-milk proposal at first; after weeks of added evidence, WWF selected it for implementation.

B.S. Energy Systems Engineering | Istanbul Bilgi University **2010 to 2014**

Istanbul, Turkey

Geothermal thesis on the Seferihisar field. The well data was private and even the local government did not hold it; tracked down Ormat's regional director, who handed it over with permission to publish, and sized a hypothetical 2 MW plant on it. Attended the Stanford Geothermal Workshop.

SKILLS

BUILDING WITH AI AGENTS: Claude Code, Codex and Cursor, with agent-written test suites and cross-model reviews (Claude and Codex); deterministic engines and MCP servers.

ENERGY MARKETS AND PROGRAMS: MISO and Kentucky (Hawesville), PJM and Virginia (Wythe), ERCOT (Base Power essay), CAISO and SCE data (PowerUP), LADWP rebate programs.

WRITING

Geothermal Is in "Heat", and this time, buyer is moving in **mrbese.com | August 2026 | mrbese.com/writing/geothermal-heat**

Argues that transmission distance, not geology, held geothermal back, and works out what Anthropic's TeraWulf campus lease comes to per MWh of IT load (near $271 at full load, for buildings and cooling, not a power-only price).

Current War II: Tesla vs Edison **mrbese.com | July 2026 | mrbese.com/writing/war-of-the-currents**

Three-part series arguing that direct current is coming back. Part three covers how DC ties let Texas trade power across its borders while ERCOT stays outside FERC's jurisdiction (FERC dockets TX11-1 and TX18-1).

What I Learned About Base Power **mrbese.com | May 2026 | mrbese.com/writing/base-power**

Primary-source essay on Base Power's ERCOT model; argues that efficiency upgrades at install raise battery export from the same inverter.

COMMUNITY

Hustle Fund Angel Squad member since 2021. On Deck founder fellowship (ODF17, 2023). Hosts seated dinners for 12 to 14 people from different parts of life.